



STEVE WESTON

Great race ... for 2nd

FOUR BASEBALL teams begin the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division pennant chase this week.

And it looks like a great race. . .

. . . For second place!

Not that any of the other teams are already conceding the title to Arizona State's Sun Devils. But the chances of Arizona, New Mexico or Texas-El Paso actually dethroning the powerful Sun Devils would seem to hover between slim and none.

"They (ASU) should legitimately be classified as the favorites," understated rookie coach Jerry Kindall of Arizona.

Most observers will concede that coach Jim Brock's Devils of 1973 are not as good (is that an accurate description?) as his team last year.

But it would appear A-State still is that much better than its Southern Division rivals.

Actually, the race could be over quickly.

The Sun Devils and Wildcats meet in Tucson Thursday, Friday and Saturday. An ASU sweep—as has been the norm of late—could start the Sun Devils towards a second consecutive undefeated swing through the Southern Division.

New Mexico is enjoying a winning season—coach Bob Leigh's Lobos have a terrific record at this point. Still, New Mexico's material shouldn't match up to ASU's.

Coach Andy Cohen's UTEP Miners are winning (15-10). In fact, he might have more players than he's had in recent years.

But to consider UTEP a title contender at this point is unimaginable.

More likely, Arizona will be the chief contender . . . so what else is new?

"We've got to play our very best in order to win it," said Kindall, whose Wildcats take a 21-11 record into the ASU series.

"We can't afford a bad game or a bad series. If we are at our best game after game, then we have a chance. We have the kind of team that his to scratch, claw, dig and execute in order to win."

Pitching (isn't it always?) is again the Wildcats' problem when it comes to butting heads with the Sun Devils.

"Right now," said Kindall, "we have five guys from whom we can pick (to pitch against ASU). I will pick the pitchers as early in the week as I can."

"But right now, I don't think I can draw any conclusions so far as our pitching is concerned."

To have any hopes of winning the division race, it would appear UofA would have to win at least two of the three games in Tucson.

"I'm not setting any goals for our guys," said Kindall. "I won't tell them they have to sweep ASU . . . or even take two of the three."

"Of course, I would be disappointed if we did worse than win two."

Writers, announcers in awards

Associated Press

SALISBURY, N.C. — The 14th annual award dinner of the National Sportscasters and Sportswriters Association will be held tonight at Catawba College.

National winners in the writing and broadcasting fields of sports coverage will be announced at the dinner. Previously announced state winners, chosen by their colleagues, also will receive awards.

The four finalists in the national sportscaster voting are Curt Gowdy, NBC; Keith Jackson, ABC; Ray Scott, CBS and Hughes Sports Network, and Chris Schenkel, ABC.

The sportswriter finalists are Melvin Durslag, Los Angeles Times; Joe Falls, Detroit Free Press; Jim Murray, Los Angeles Times, and Red Smith, New York Times.

A full day of activity begins today with a breakfast for the guests, at which the speaker will be Enos Slaughter, Duke baseball coach and longtime major league player.

Clinics will be conducted by Byron Nelson and Sharron Moran in golf; Ton Trabert in tennis; Jesse Owens in track; Micki King in diving, and Gordie Howe in Hockey.

A highlight of the dinner will be the induction into the NSSA Hall of Fame of "Red" Barber and the late Arch Ward.

Barber, who now lives in Tallahassee, Fla., for more than three decades, was play-by-play announcer for the Cincinnati Reds, Brooklyn Dodgers and New York Yankees.

Ward, for more than 20 years sports editor of the Chicago Tribune, originated the All-Star baseball and football games.

Cactus results

OAKLAND	ab	r	h	bi	CALIFORNIA	ab	r	h	bi
North dh	4	1	0	0	Meoli 2b	4	1	1	0
Maxville ss	4	2	3	2	Vientine cf	2	0	0	0
Ruggi lf	5	1	1	1	Stanton rf	2	0	0	0
McKinney lf	0	0	0	0	Berry rf-cf	4	0	0	0
Bando 3b	5	0	1	0	Oliver 1b	3	1	1	0
Tenace 1b	2	0	0	1	Spencer dh	4	0	1	1
Crislaro cf	4	1	2	1	Howard lf	4	0	3	1
Mangual rf	5	0	0	0	Spiezio 3b	3	1	0	0
Fosse c	4	2	1	1	Cardenas ss	3	0	0	0
Kubiak 2b	4	1	2	1	Kusner c	4	0	2	1
Totals	37	8	17	7	Totals	33	3	8	3